1st Edgemead Cubs

Theme: **"The Great Water Rescue Adventure"**

Date	9 June 2026		Duty Six:	**Red**	
Time	**Min**	**Activity**	**Equipment**	**Leader**	**Adult Leaders tasks**
18:00	5	Grand Howl ; Inspection; Hands, Nails, Uniform, Badges, Sweet and 10 pts for a knot		Akela	Adults join in and assist Cubs around them
"Cubs, we have an urgent mission! Our rivers are in danger—pollution is spreading, and we need a team of brave Water Rescuers to save them. Today, you'll train, investigate, and take action to help restore clean water to the world!"					
18:05	10	**Rescue the River:** The river is under attack from pollution! Some of you will accidentally cause pollution, and others must save the river before it's too late!" **Game:** • Two teams: ○ **Polluters** ○ **Water Rescuers** • Polluters throw "pollution" into the river • Rescuers race in to remove it - Cubs can only carry one item at a time "Was it easy to keep the river clean? Imagine this happening every day!"	Pollution Items Plastic, paper, tins, anything you can find Draw "river" with chalk	Adult Leaders	
"Cubs, you've just seen how pollution affects our rivers—but here's something surprising… pollution doesn't only stay on the ground. Gold Wolves, your next mission starts now! Silver Wolves; Our river needed rescuing just now—and in real life, many rivers need help too. Let's discover what's causing all this pollution!""					
Silver Wolves					
18:15	20	What Went Wrong?" Investigation "You've arrived at the polluted river. Your job as Water Rescuers is to figure out what caused the damage." **Teach 3 Causes:** 1. **Littering** – plastics and rubbish		Hathi	Chil sets up water filter making and Baloo the acidrain station Akela will take the Chums to the side to cover membership advancements

		• A plastic bottle can take **over 400 years** to break down! • Many animals think plastic is food and can get very sick or even die from eating it. • Rain can wash litter from streets **straight into rivers and the ocean**. • Even small items like sweet wrappers can harm fish and birds. • If rubbish is left on the ground, it almost **always ends up in water eventually**. "If it's on the ground, it can reach the water!" **2. Chemicals & Factory Waste** • Some factories release **dirty or toxic water** into rivers if not controlled. • Oil spills can cover water and stop fish and plants from getting oxygen. • Chemicals in water can make animals sick—even if the water *looks clean*. • Soap, cleaning products, and paint washed down drains can harm rivers. • Once chemicals are in the water, they can be **very hard to remove**. "Not all pollution can be seen—clear water is not always clean!" **3. Runoff - Rain Washing Dirt & Chemicals** • When it rains, water washes **everything on the ground** into drains and rivers. • Fertilisers from gardens or farms can cause **too much plant growth in water**, which can kill fish. • Soap from washing cars or pavements can pollute rivers. • Oil from roads can be washed into stormwater systems. • Stormwater drains often go **directly to rivers or the ocean—without cleaning the water first**.			

		" Rain doesn't clean pollution—it moves it!" Show items and ask: "Is this something that could harm our river?"			
"Now that we've discovered what's harming the river, it's time for the most important part of our mission—fixing it!"					
18:35	10	Undoing Water Pollution **"The Clean-Up Plan"** "The river can still be saved—but only if we work together to find solutions." Each team gets a "mission problem": • Litter-filled river • Chemical spill • Dirty runoff They answer: • What caused it? • How do we fix it? • How do we prevent it? "We can help clean water—but stopping pollution is even better!"	Pictures of "mission problems"	Hathi	Each six gets a problem and they have to list in their group what caused the problem, how can we fix it and what can we do in future to prevent it. Points for 'out of the box' ideas
"We've learned how water gets dirty and how we can help fix it—now it's time to roll up our sleeves and become real Water Rescuers by building our very own filters to help clean the water!"					
18:45	30	**Step 1: Prepare the Bottle** • Turn the **top half of the bottle upside down** (like a funnel) • Place it into the bottom half or into a cup *Explain:* "This will act like our filter system." **Step 2: Add the First Layer (Cloth/Cotton)** • Place **cloth, cotton wool, or a coffee filter** at the bottom (the bottle neck) *Explain:* "This layer stops the smallest dirt from passing through." **Step 3: Add Sand Layer**	Empty plastic bottle (cut in half) Sand (fine) Small stones/pebbles Gravel Coffee filter	Adult Leaders	

		• Pour in a layer of **fine sand** *Explain:* "Sand catches tiny particles we can't easily see." **Step 4: Add Small Stones** • Add a layer of **small pebbles or gravel** *Explain:* "These trap bigger bits of dirt and debris." **Step 5: Add Larger Stones (Top Layer)** • Add **larger stones** at the top *Explain:* "This helps catch large pieces like leaves and litter first." **Step 6: Pour Dirty Water Slowly** • Carefully pour dirty water into the top *Important:* Go slowly to avoid mixing the layers **Step 7: Watch the Water Drip Through** • Observe as water filters into the container Ask Cubs: • "Is it clearer?" • "What changed?" Always say: "This water may look cleaner, but it is **NOT safe to drink**." **Discussion Questions** • Which layer worked the best? • What got trapped at the top vs bottom? • Is it easy or hard to clean water?	Dirty water (prepared beforehand) Cup to catch filtered water		
GOLD WOLVES:					
"Pollution doesn't stop on land—it can rise into the sky and return as acid rain. Let's explore how."					

18:15	5	**The Acid Rain Investigation"** "Acid rain is rain that has been **polluted by dirty air**. When smoke and gases from cars and factories go into the sky, they mix with clouds and turn into **acid rain**." • Acid rain is caused by **air pollution** (cars, factories, burning fuels) • It falls as **rain, mist, or even snow** • It can **harm plants, animals, rivers, and buildings** • It can make water in rivers **too acidic for fish to survive** • It can damage forests by **burning leaves and weakening trees** "Dirty air can turn into harmful rain!"		Baloo	
18:20	30	**"Silent Damage"** ◆ **Step 1:** • Label one cup: **"Normal Rain"** • Label the other: **"Acid Rain"** ◆ **Step 2:** • Cup 1: Add **clean water** • Cup 2: Add **water + a splash of vinegar** Explain: "The vinegar makes the water acidic—like acid rain." ◆ **Step 3:** • Place a leaf/apple/chalk piece into each cup **Step 4:** • Immediate: look for bubbles (especially on chalk) • Over time (10–20 mins or longer): ○ Colour changes ○ Softening ○ Damage	2 clear cups or jars Water Vinegar 2 leaves OR slices of apple OR pieces of chalk	Baloo	

		• Vinegar (acid rain) may: ○ Make chalk fizz or dissolve ○ Make leaves/apple look damaged faster Ask: • "Which one is changing faster?" • "Which looks healthier?" "Acid rain doesn't always damage things instantly—but over time it can harm plants, animals, and even buildings." **How It Affects the Planet** • Trees get weaker and struggle to grow • Fish can die if water becomes too acidic • Rocks and buildings can slowly wear away • Soil loses important nutrients **How We Can Help** • Use less electricity • Walk or carpool when possible • Don't burn rubbish • Look after nature "Cleaner air = cleaner rain!"			
"Cubs, just like we've seen pollution can harm our water and air—but nature has its own way of fighting back… plants!"					
18:40	5	• Plants absorb **carbon dioxide** (a pollutant) • They release **oxygen** (which we need to breathe) • Leaves can trap **dust and dirt from the air** • Trees help cool the environment and reduce pollution Simple message: "Plants help clean the air we breathe!"		Chil	
"Let's test how plants help trap pollution from the air!"					
18:45		**Step 1:**			

		• Lightly cover one leaf with a thin layer of petroleum jelly Explain: "This represents how leaves can trap tiny particles in the air." **Step 2:** • Leave another surface (card/paper) plain **Step 3:** • Place both items in the same area (or gently sprinkle a tiny bit of dry soil/dust nearby) **Step 4:** • After a few minutes, check both **Observation** • The leaf (sticky surface) will collect more dust • The plain surface will have less sticking **Explain** "Leaves act like natural filters—they catch dust, dirt, and pollution from the air!" Cubs also pick a leaf outside the Scout Hall and wipe it with cotton wool to show dirt collected **Explanation** **"How Plants Help Our Planet"** **Teach simply:** • Trees act like **giant air filters** • Forests help clean the air for cities • Without plants: ○ Air would be dirtier ○ It would be harder to breathe ○ Temperatures would rise	Leaves Vaseline Paper/card Sprinkle a little soil lightly		

		Fun fact: "A single large tree can produce enough oxygen for **several people**!" **Ask Cubs:** • Why should we protect trees? • What happens if we cut too many trees down?			
Plants are real-life superheroes—they clean our air every single day. If we protect them, they protect us."					
19:15	5	Clean-up and pack away			
19:20	5	Grand Howl Flag down Closing prayer Good Hunting Cubs		Akela	
Advancements					
SW Awareness 	1. Causes /solutions to water pollution 2. Water / Air Demonstration				
GW Awareness 	1. Find out and demonstrate acid rain 2. How plants fight air pollution				